

LF Sentence Combining

WHAT THIS SKILL MEANS

This skill is about connecting two ideas into one sentence instead of saying them as two separate, short sentences. “The cost is high. The savings are good.” are two disconnected thoughts. “Although the cost is high, the savings justify it” shows the relationship between them. Strong speakers don’t just list ideas — they show how those ideas relate within a single sentence.

WHAT TO TRY

- Notice when you’re producing a string of short sentences and look for the relationship between them
- Choose a connector that matches the real relationship — because, although, if, when, since — not just “and”
- Combine a cause and its effect into one sentence rather than stating them separately

SENTENCE STARTERS

- “Although [X], [Y]...”
- “[X] because [Y]...”
- “If [X], then [Y]...”
- “Since [X], it follows that [Y]...”

EXAMPLE IN ACTION

Although making transit free would increase ridership significantly, the city would need a new funding source, since fare collection currently pays for a meaningful share of operating costs. The relationship between increased ridership, lost revenue, and the reason for that loss is carried entirely inside one connected sentence, not stated as three separate facts.